of cattle and live stock. They are now encamped about the snow hills to the south of the town. They come into town every now and then, and come to make their bows to me, and sometimes bring me presents of lambs, butter, and curds. They will be most of them down at the village in another month or so. I do not think I shall be able to go to the villages until the end of Sepr or beginning of October. This is the time that the cotton plants are in full bearing, the ground is measured and the dues taken on that which produces. I want to be there as little as I can help in their abominable fast month, "Ramazan," which lasts from the 14th of Sepr to the 14th of Octr. I do not like to see poor fellows working twelve hours under a hot sun, and to know that they have tasted nothing, not even a drink of water, or a pipe, since an hour before sun rise and can taste nothing until a quarter of an hour after.

A French chargé d'affaires M. de Sartige[74] has arrived here he is going to Tehran to try to persuade the Shah to allow French Jesuit priests to come to Persia. They have been here several times before and have been turned out for the intrigues and the disturbances they made.[75] I do not wish him success, these gentry make quarrels amongst the Europeans and do mischief. — Otherwise they are many of them intelligent and well informed men. I never saw but one blockhead amongst them, and he was only a lay brother.

Poor old Wolf is I am afraid detained at Bokhara it is said that villain of an Ameer will not let him go.[76]

[EDWARD BURGESS TO MRS. HENRY BURGESS] *Tabreez, October 7, 1844*

This year I missed the speechifying [at my villages]. I did it on purpose, it appeared to me so utterly ridiculous to have to make a speech in a language which I talk by no means well. Altho I may say without boasting that I know of no European who either is, or has been in Persia who talks or talked it better except the late Dr Cormick. The people came to me by fours and fives and I spoke to them civilly and sent them off again. Flattering myself that by so doing I had escaped the bore of a public meeting and speech making. However I had not been back ten days before in came a villager with a letter to me signed by a great number of the villagers demanding to change their chief, in fact to have a fresh election.

Now as this man has been confirmed by me, they can not well turn him out without my permission, but at the same time if a large majority are determined

[74] Count de Sartige, later French ambassador to the United States.

[75] Justin Perkins, op. cit., frequently makes the same complaint.

[76] For a contemporary account of the Bokhara incident, involving the murders of Capt. Stoddart and Lieut. Conolly by the Emir of Bokhara, see Capt. John Grover, *The Bokhara victims*, London, 1845.

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